



December 2, 2025

Stronger Homes, Stronger Spartanburg

University of South Carolina Upstate
Public Relations Campaigns - JOUR U428

Mary Kathryn Chandler



Tactic 3: Mary Kathryn Chandler - Newsletter

Newsletter:



Full PDF Here: [RTSNewsletter.pdf](#)

Link to Video:

https://www.canva.com/design/DAG5WOuAxxw/k4dC2vMK87jsDo2lfNUW4A/edit?utm_content=DAG5WOuAxxw&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=sharebutton

Strategies for Gaining Subscribers:

Strategy 1: Push QR Codes at Events

Use community-centered outreach by placing newsletter QR codes at high-traffic events where RTS already has a presence, including volunteer build days, project kickoffs, partner organization fairs, fundraising dinners, information booths at local festivals, and more. This strategy encourages quick, convenient sign-ups when people are already engaged with RTS,

thereby increasing awareness, strengthening community ties, and making newsletter subscriptions more accessible to our audiences.

Strategy 2: Newsletter Subscriber Discounts with Local Partners

Partner with businesses in the Upstate, including Home Depot, Lowe's, Habitat ReStore, and select community shops such as Little River Coffee Bar and Spill the Beans, to offer small discounts exclusive to newsletter subscribers. This will benefit local companies and us by helping us increase subscriptions and deliver real value for subscribers. It also supports local businesses by increasing foot traffic.

Social Media Post:



RTS T-SHIRTS ARE HERE!

Join our newsletter this month to be entered for a chance to win a FREE RTS T-Shirt!

Winner will be announced on October 13th at noon EST.

DON'T WANT TO WAIT? ORDER NOW!

WWW.RTSPART.ORG/JOIN

Caption: We love our volunteers and supporters, and now you can rep RTS wherever you go! Subscribe to our newsletter for your chance to win a free RTS shirt and show your support for safe and healthy homes in Spartanburg. The winner will be announced on October 13th!

#RebuildingTogetherSpartanburg #RTSfamily
#SpartanburgSC #CommunityImpact
#NonprofitLife #MakeADifference #UpstateSC
#Giveaway #SupportLocalNonprofits #RTSpart

Timeline:

December 2025:

- December 1st: Hold the monthly planning meeting, outline newsletter themes, assign stories, and discuss the rollout schedule for the QR code and partner discount strategies.
- December 5th: Begin drafting December stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- December 8th: Design initial QR codes for newsletter sign-ups.
- December 10th: Identify high-traffic RTS events for QR code placement next year.
- December 12th: First editorial review of the December newsletter.
- December 23rd: Final Editorial review of the December Newsletter.

- December 25th: Send out December Newsletter.
- December 29th: Plan out the theme for the January 2026 newsletter.
- December 30th: Review engagement - Full-year evaluation.

January 2026:

- January 1st: Hold the monthly planning meeting, outline newsletter themes, assign stories, and discuss the rollout schedule for the QR code and partner discount strategies.
- January 5th: Begin drafting January stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- January 10th: Start outreach to potential discount partners.
- January 12th: First editorial review of January newsletter.
- January 20th: Print first round of QR posters for volunteer build days.
- January 24th: Final Editorial review of January Newsletter.
- January 25th: Send out January Newsletter.
- January 30th: Review engagement.

February 2026:

- February 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign February stories.
- February 5th: Begin drafting February stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- February 8th: Continue to build connections with partner businesses for newsletter subscriber discounts.
- February 12th: First editorial review of the February newsletter.
- February 24th: Final editorial review of the February newsletter.
- February 25th: Send out February newsletter.
- February 28th: Review engagement.

March 2026:

- March 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign March stories.
- March 5th: Begin drafting March stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- March 12th: First editorial review of the March newsletter.
- March 15th: Print and place QR code sign-up stands at RTS project kickoffs and spring fundraising dinners.
- March 24th: Final editorial review of the March newsletter.
- March 25th: Send March newsletter.
- March 30th: Review engagement.

April 2026:

- April 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign April stories.
- April 5th: Begin drafting April stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- April 12th: First editorial review of April newsletter.
- April 20th: Finalize agreements with partner businesses for subscriber discounts.

- April 24th: Final editorial review of April newsletter.
- April 25th: Send out April newsletter.
- April 30th: Review engagement.

May 2026:

- May 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign May stories.
- May 5th: Begin drafting May stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- May 12th: First editorial review of May newsletter.
- May 15th: Explain QR placements to partner businesses through countertop displays.
- May 24th: Final editorial review of May newsletter.
- May 25th: Send out May newsletter.
- May 30th: Review engagement.

June 2026:

- June 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign June stories.
- June 5th: Begin drafting June stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- June 12th: First editorial review of the June newsletter.
- June 15th: Promote subscriber discount program at all booths during June festivals.
- June 24th: Final editorial review of June newsletter.
- June 25th: Send out June newsletter.
- June 30th: Review engagement.

July 2026:

- July 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign July stories.
- July 5th: Begin drafting July stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- July 12th: First editorial review of the July newsletter.
- July 15th: Update QR code graphics for summer community festivals.
- July 24th: Final editorial review of the July newsletter.
- July 25th: Send out July newsletter.
- July 30th: Review engagement.

August 2026:

- August 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign August stories.
- August 5th: Begin drafting August stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- August 12th: First editorial review of the August newsletter.
- August 24th: Final editorial review of the August newsletter.
- August 25th: Send out August newsletter.
- August 30th: Review engagement.

September 2026:

- September 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign September stories.

- September 5th: Begin drafting September stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- September 12th: First editorial review of the September newsletter.
- September 16th: Begin shaping content plan for upcoming 30th anniversary email feature.
- September 24th: Final editorial review of September newsletter.
- September 25th: Send out September newsletter.
- September 26th: Run partner-discount reminder to bring in more subscribers.
- September 30th: Review engagement.

October 2026:

- October 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign October stories.
- October 2nd: Update QR code signage to redirect to anniversary event sign-up + newsletter.
- October 5th: Begin drafting October stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- October 6th: Prepare T-shirt Feature Section
- October 12th: First editorial review of the October newsletter.
- October 15th: Push QR Codes at fall festivals and RTS community booths.
- October 24th: Final editorial review of the October newsletter.
- October 25th: Send out October newsletter.
- October 30th: Review engagement.

November 2026:

- November 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign November stories.
- November 2nd: Prepare anniversary QR code displays.
- November 5th: Begin drafting November stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- November 12th: First editorial review of the November newsletter.
- November 24th: Final editorial review of the November newsletter.
- November 25th: Send out November newsletter.
- November 30th: Review engagement.

December 2026:

- December 1st: Monthly editorial planning meeting and assign November stories.
- December 2nd: Send December newsletter with Anniversary Event Recap.
- December 5th: Begin drafting November stories, confirm Volunteer/Donor profile, and Home repair tip of the month.
- December 12th: First editorial review of the November newsletter.
- December 15th: Promote the partner discount for holiday shopping in the newsletter.
- December 23rd: Final editorial review of the November newsletter.
- December 25th: Send out November newsletter.
- December 30th: Review engagement - Full-year evaluation.

- **Budget:**

1. Software Subscriptions:

- a. Constant Contact Lite: \$12 a month

Total: \$144

2. Printing

- 5 Foamboard Posters at \$25.99 each from Office Depot
- QR code cards - 5 x 250 cards for \$21.99 from Office Depot

Total: \$239.90

Evaluation

To evaluate the effectiveness of the newsletter rollout and its subscriber growth strategies, I would use two evaluation methods. The first method is subscriber analytics within Constant Contact. This includes tracking month-to-month subscriber growth, open rates, click-through rates, and the number of new subscribers from the QR codes. Since our strategies heavily rely on in-person QR code placements and discount incentives, tracking the patterns of growth following major events will allow us to measure which placements and time periods produce the most engagement. This data will be reliable, objective, and give a clear picture of whether our audience is growing.

The second method would be partner-based tracking through our discount partners. Each participating business in the subscriber discount program can record how many RTS subscribers redeemed offers each month. This can help provide insight into whether our discount program drives engagement or if it needs adjustments. High redemption rates would indicate that the subscribers believe the newsletter offers real value and motivates them to stay engaged with the newsletter. Low engagement rates would suggest that we need to edit the incentive or find a better way to promote the program.

Together, these tools will help us evaluate whether the newsletter is meeting its objective of increasing volunteer and donor engagement and identify which components are most effective.

Appendix

Tactic 3:

Clear pricing, big potential.

Prepay and nonprofit discounts

Monthly | Prepay 6 months SAVE 10% | Prepay 12 months SAVE 15% | Nonprofit? ☐

Number of contacts: 0 - 500

Recommended

Lite

\$12⁰⁰ /month*

Ideal for beginners

Start marketing with award-winning email and social media tools.

Select Lite

Standard

\$35⁰⁰ /month*

Great for most businesses

Grow faster with powerful automated marketing tools.

Select Standard

Premium

\$80⁰⁰ /month*

Ideal for pros

Get industry-leading tools for automation, segmentation, and more.

Select Premium

*Plan price is based on number of contacts and email sends. Overage fees may apply.

Paper deals as low as \$29.99 | Black Friday Deals | 25% off \$125 purchase of Print Services

Office DEPOT OfficeMax | Products | Services | Print & Copy | Deals | Search | Help | Account Log In | Cart

Imagine Success™ | 2% back in Rewards | FREE Same Day Delivery on qualifying items | FREE Store Pickup in 15 minutes | 20+ Employee Businesses | More | Store | Deliver to: 29631

16" x 20" Foamboard Posters | Back | 16" x 20" Foamboard Posters Untitled | Design | Poster Types | Print Options | Review

Choose Quantity: 1 | Buy more, save more!

2 for \$24.99 ea. Save \$1.00 ea.	3 for \$23.99 ea. Save \$2.00 ea.	6 for \$22.99 ea. Save \$3.00 ea.
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Standard Business Cards | Back | Standard Business Cards Untitled | Design | Card Types | Print Options | Review

Choose Quantity

250 1 box \$21.99 per Box	500 2 boxes \$14.99 per Box	1000 4 boxes \$13.99 per Box	2000 8 boxes \$12.99 per Box	3000 12 boxes \$11.99 per Box	5000 20 boxes \$10.99 per Box
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Choose Paper

14pt Uncoated Smooth surface, easy to write on allowing businesses to use as appointment cards. +\$8.00	14pt Gloss High gloss shine on the front side, and matte on back. +\$1.00	RECOMMENDED 14pt Matte Substantial enough to withstand printing on both sides with easy to read text without glare.
16pt Matte Thick and durable with a coated matte finish with added rigidity preventing	18pt Gloss Extra sturdy feel with a high gloss finish on the front side, matte on back.	12pt Pearl A pearlescent finish on both sides used for high end business cards.

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